Facing spread: front end / 1

Review characters first. Copy and 16 pt styling are provisional. Outer margins are review space.

Finding Our Inner Voice

Interior only. Cover, final lettering and asset cleanup remain separate finishing work.

Facing spread: 2 / 3

Review characters first. Copy and 16 pt styling are provisional. Outer margins are review space.

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Facing spread: 4 / 5

Review characters first. Copy and 16 pt styling are provisional. Outer margins are review space.

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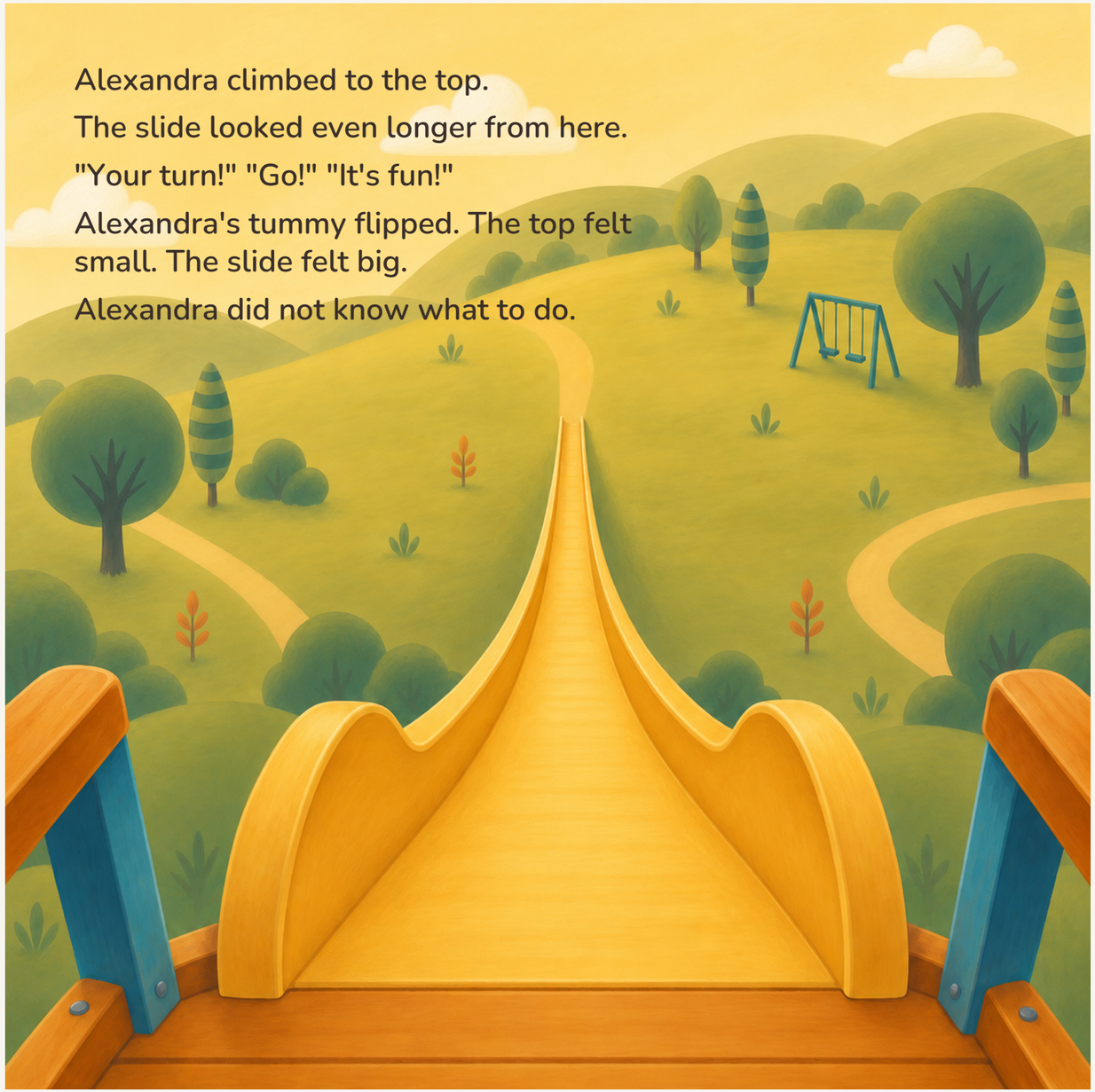
Swings. Tunnels. Sand. A climbing wall like a mountain.
Alexandra looked left, then right. "What should I try first?"
Then came a whoosh from way up high.

It was the tall slide.
Kids climbed up. Kids sat down. Kids whooshed all the way to the bottom.
"Again, again!" they shouted.
Alexandra looked up.
The slide looked fun. It also looked very, very tall.

Facing spread: 8 / 9

Review characters first. Copy and 16 pt styling are provisional. Outer margins are review space.



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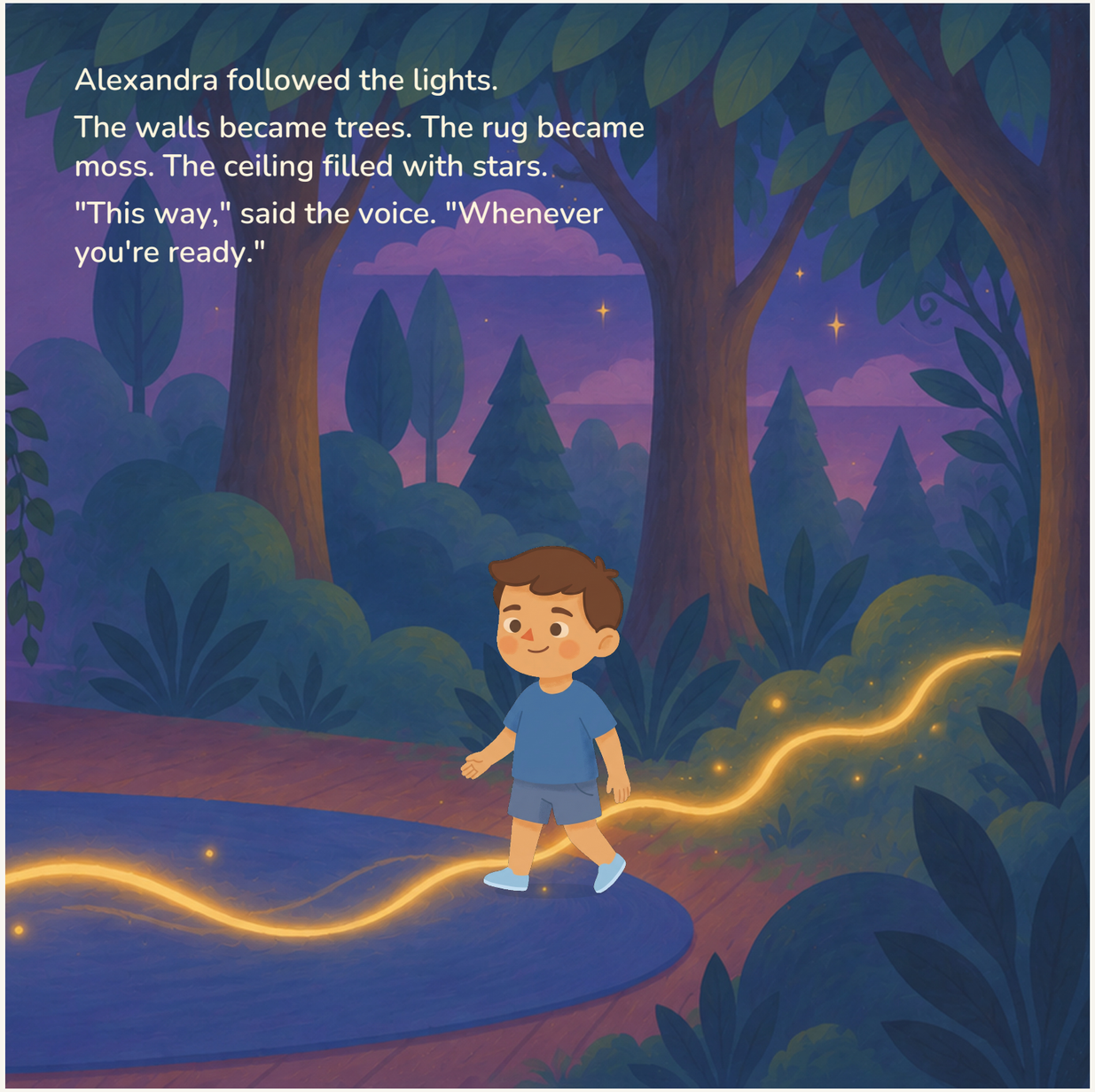
Facing spread: 10 / 11

Review characters first. Copy and 16 pt styling are provisional. Outer margins are review space.



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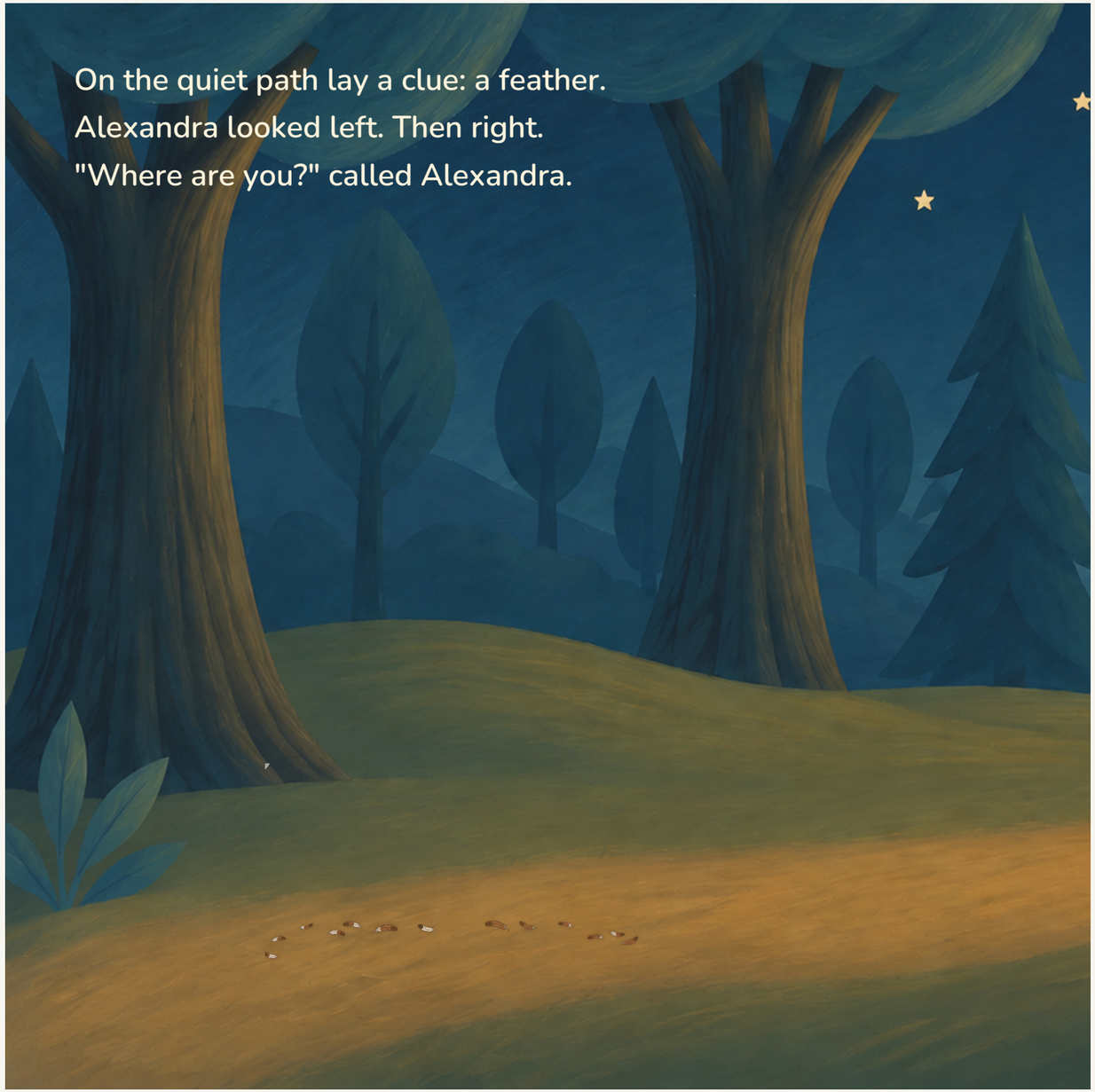
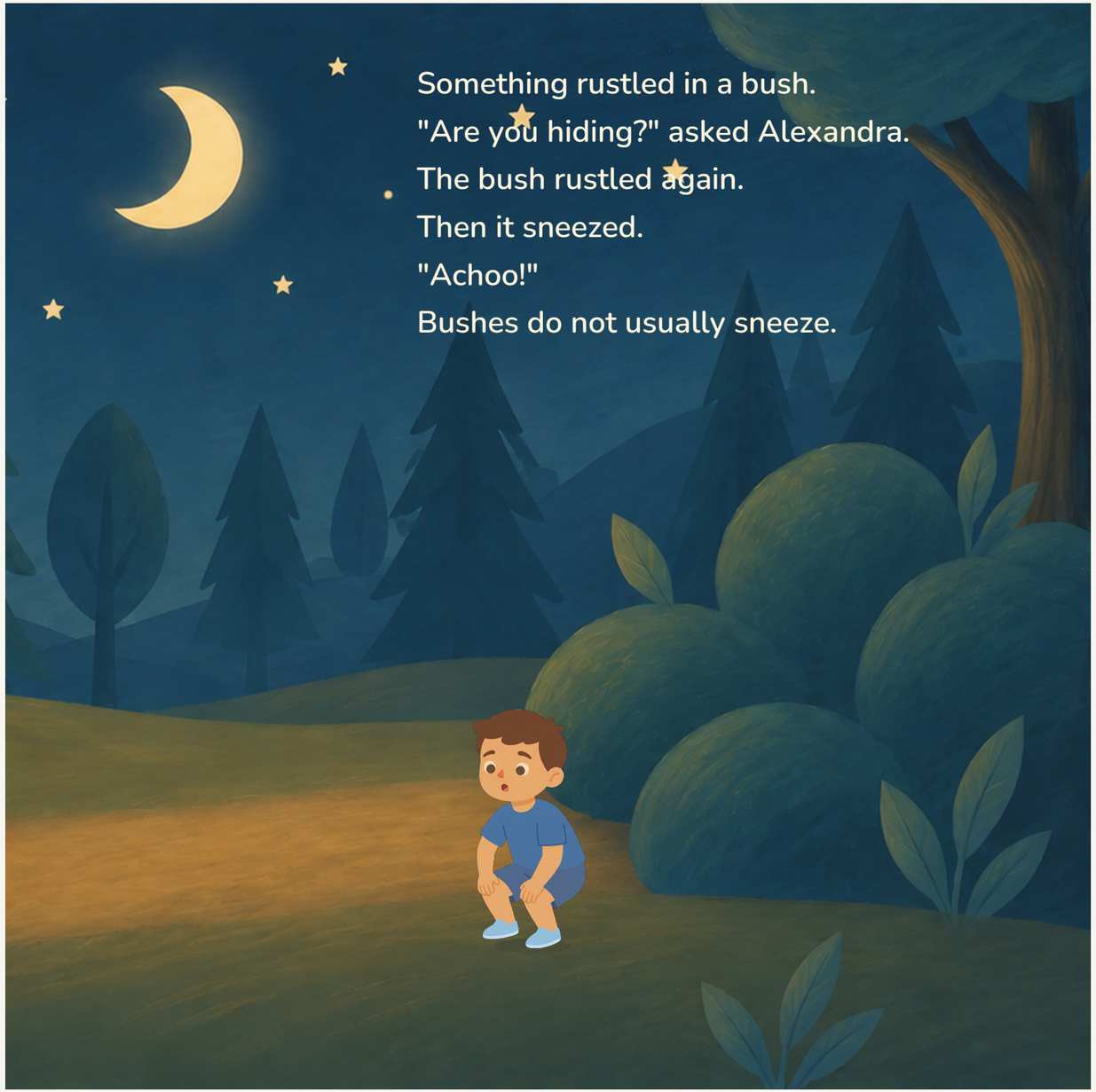
Facing spread: 12 / 13

Review characters first. Copy and 16 pt styling are provisional. Outer margins are review space.





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Facing spread: 14 / 15

Review characters first. Copy and 16 pt styling are provisional. Outer margins are review space.

Before Alexandra could peek, voices called from every direction.

"This way!" blinked a star. "No, this way!" puffed the wind. "Hop!" said a mushroom. "Skip!" said a stone.

A sign spun around. "HURRY!"

One breath

"Too many voices make it hard to hear your own," said the tiny voice.

Alexandra stopped. One slow breath.

Alexandra listened for the small, true voice inside.

"Listen close. I'm still here."

And there it was: a quiet path.

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Facing spread: 16 / 17

Review characters first. Copy and 16 pt styling are provisional. Outer margins are review space.

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Alexandra felt scared. Alexandra's tummy felt tight.

"YOU CAN'T!" "YOU'RE TOO LITTLE!" The tiny voice echoed through the cave.

YOU CAN'T!
YOU'RE TOO LITTLE!

A wall blocked the path. The same words glowed on it in big, prickly letters.

The tiny voice didn't sound friendly now.

"Why do you sound mean?" asked Alexandra.

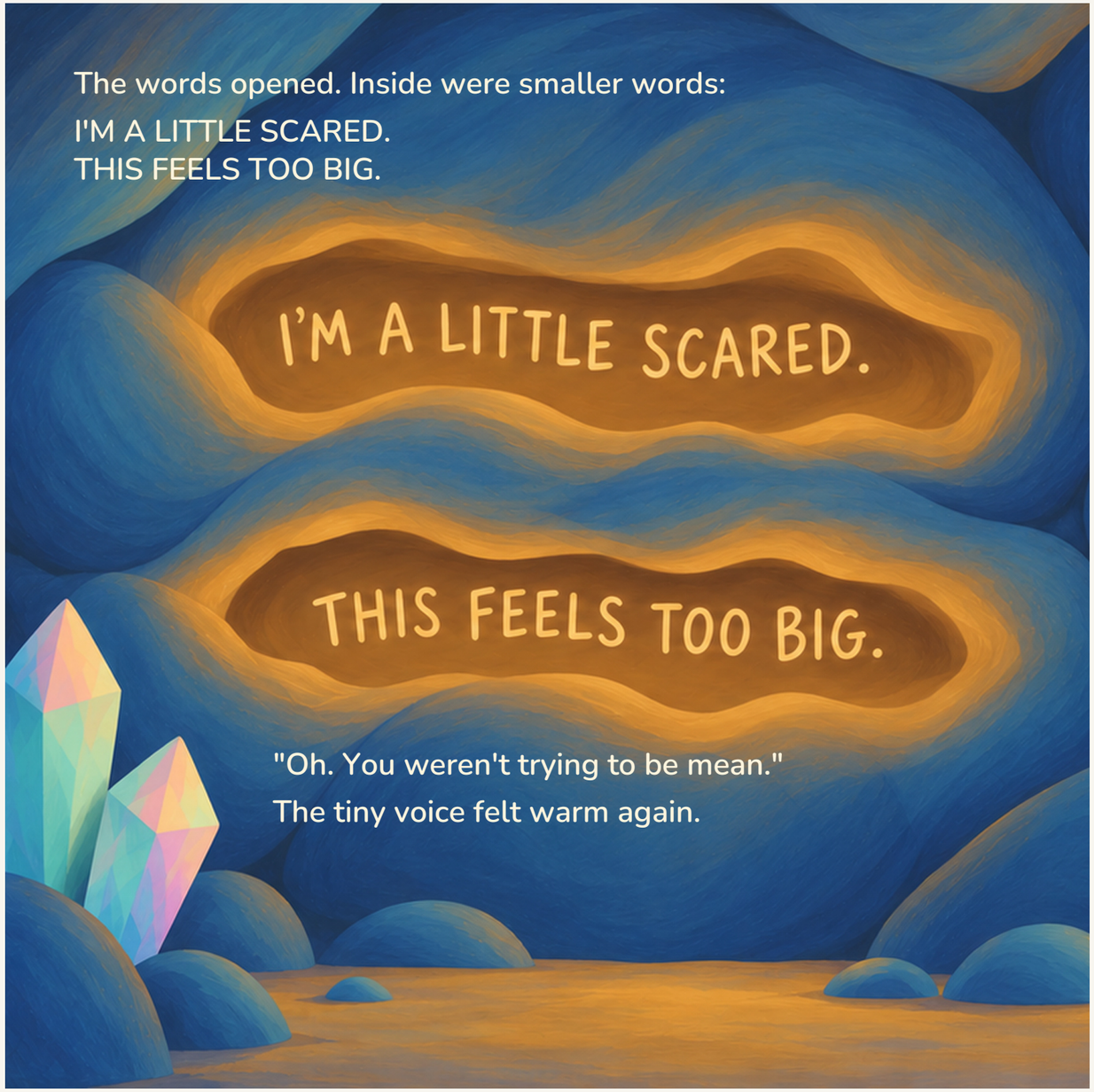
The voice was quiet.

Alexandra remembered. One deep breath. Then another.

The cave grew quieter. The prickly words wiggled. Then softened.

Facing spread: 20 / 21

Review characters first. Copy and 16 pt styling are provisional. Outer margins are review space.



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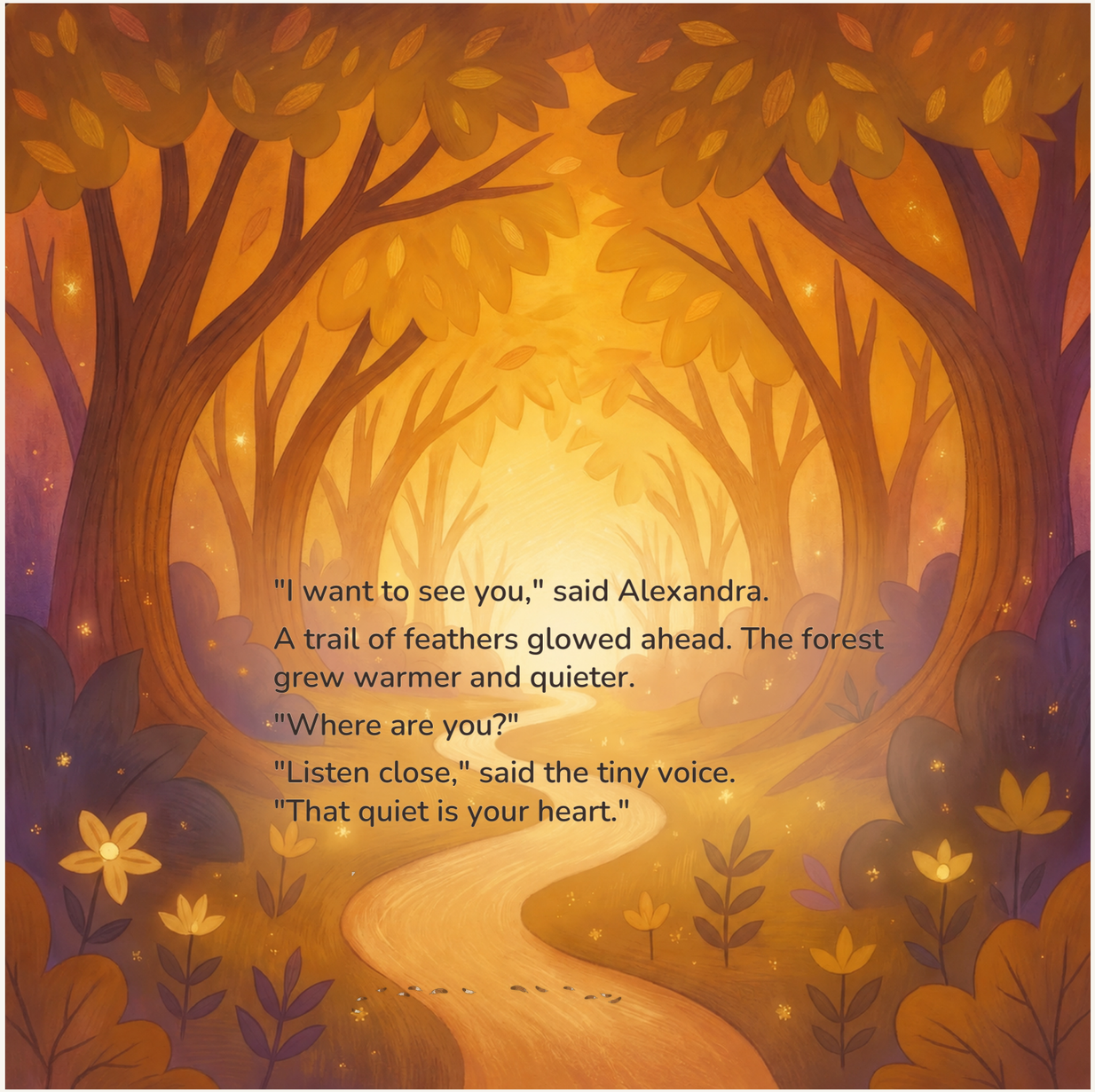
The prickles fell away. The wall shimmered. The cave opened wide.

Beyond it, the world was bright.

Alexandra stepped through.

Alexandra ran into the sunlight. Alexandra felt a little better now.

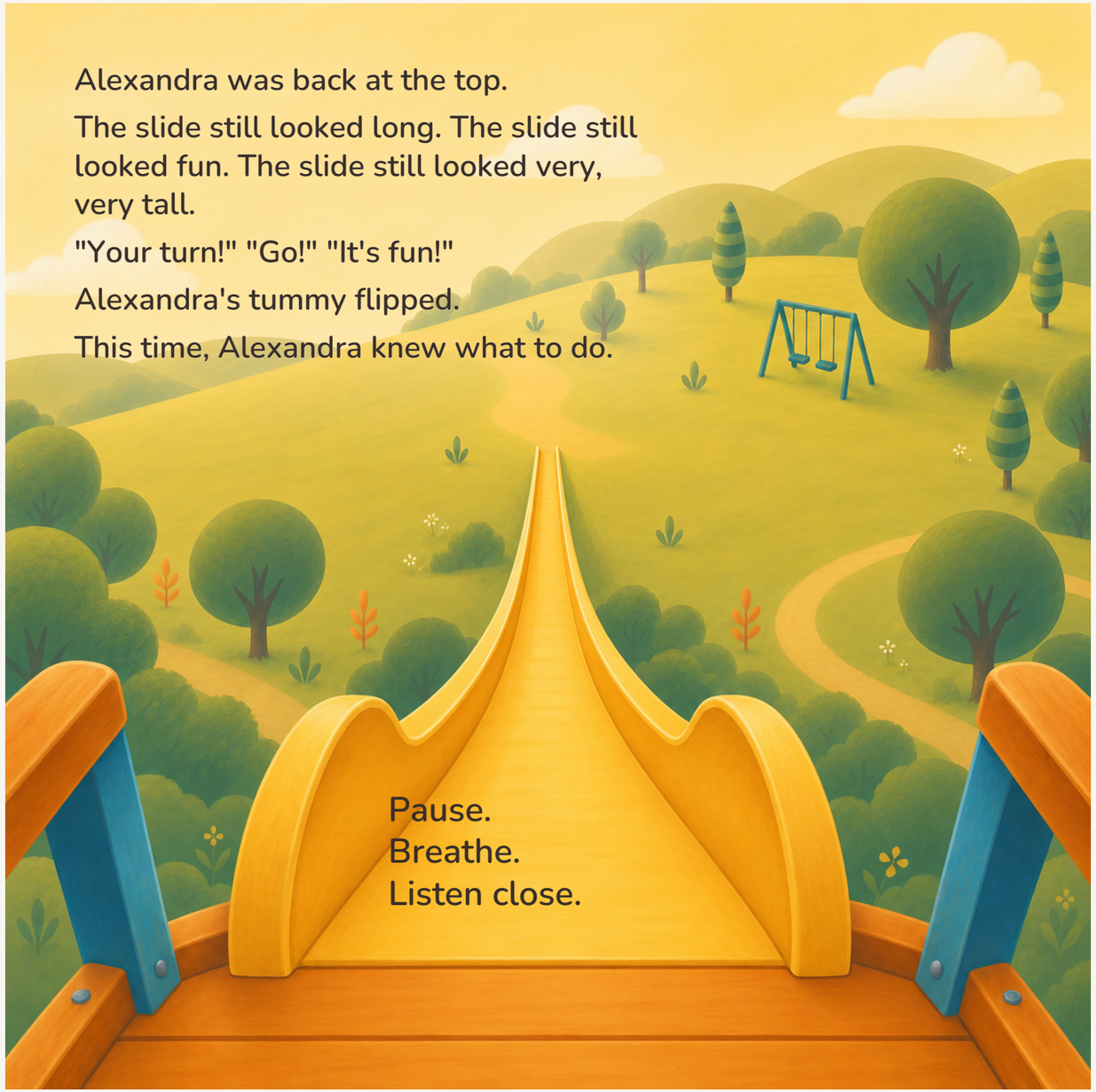
Now Alexandra understood. The tiny voice helped them notice what felt scary, what felt wrong, and what felt right.


"I want to see you," said Alexandra.
A trail of feathers glowed ahead. The forest grew warmer and quieter.
"Where are you?"
"Listen close," said the tiny voice.
"That quiet is your heart."

In a warm, magical clearing, Owl appeared.
Alexandra gasped. "It was you?"
Owl smiled.
"I am your quiet voice," said Owl, "in a shape you can see."
The warm quiet was inside Alexandra, too.

Facing spread: 26 / 27

Review characters first. Copy and 16 pt styling are provisional. Outer margins are review space.



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Facing spread: 28 / 29

Review characters first. Copy and 16 pt styling are provisional. Outer margins are review space.

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For grown-ups

Ask your child: "Was there a time today when you felt ready, or when you wanted to wait?"

Give them time to answer.

Facing spread: 32 / back end

Review characters first. Copy and 16 pt styling are provisional. Outer margins are review space.

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